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FORECASTING

Version 3.5.2

Product Guide



FRONTISPIECE

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This product information relates to:

Forecasting Version 3.5.2

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Glossary



Glossary

Centre

A site within the company that acts as a central supply source by stocking and shipping items to regional DC's as required.

Conversion Factor

A factor that used to convert items sold in different pack sizes into equivalent units. This is achieved by multiplying quantities by the conversion factor in the demand history and forecasts (unless manually forecast).

DC

A Distribution Centre dealing directly with customers' orders, whilst normally holding minimal stock.

Error (Mean Absolute Percentage Error)

A representation of the forecast error in terms of a percentage. It is calculated as the absolute value of:

$$\frac{(Total\ Forecast\ Qty - Total\ Actual\ Qty)}{Total\ Actual\ Qty} \times 100\%$$

Where totals are accumulated over the specified simulation period.

Exponential Smoothing

A well established statistical technique used to calculate forecasts based on a moving average.

Final Forecast

The forecast quantity obtained by applying any Marketing Masks to the Initial Forecast.

Forecast Code

A letter, in the range A to G inclusive, which represents one of the forecast formulae provided within the application. You can use other letters if you have defined extra formulae and added these into the product. Alternatively, this may

be an asterisk (*) which signifies that you have manually entered or updated a forecast.

Forecast History

Forecasting automatically saves all forecasts generated, these are subsequently referred to as Forecast History.

Group

An Inventory Management Minor Item Group.

Initial Forecast

The generated forecast quantity, before any Forecasting applies Marketing Masks but after any Conversion Factor is applied.

Item

The forecasted item represented by its unique Inventory Management Item Code.

Lock in Forecast

A Forecast Code representing the definitive forecast formula for the Group or Item.

If specified in the range A to G, then the corresponding formula will be applied automatically, in other words, without simulation, in the Month-end run.

Manual Forecast

A forecast designated as being manually controlled, in other words, it will be ignored by the Month-end run and the forecasts are keyed in by the user.

Marketing Masks

A set of twelve or thirteen factors, one per period, which are used to cater for any future demand which is not obvious from the demand history. These are particularly useful where there is a limited demand history, or where Sales/Marketing exercises are to be undertaken.

These factors are used to multiply the Initial Forecast for the corresponding period.

Model

Within Forecasting this represents a logical grouping of Inventory stockrooms for the purpose of creating consolidated item & group forecasts.

Simulation

A process of regressing in time whilst evaluating each of the Forecast formulae. This evaluation is done by comparing the forecasted quantities with the actual demand history to calculate an error.

Simulation Period

The length of time, in months, over which the simulation is to be performed.

Spread Profile

A representation of how the monthly forecasts in Forecasting are to be split into weekly forecasts for use by DRP, MPS or MRP.

Seasonal Profile

A representation of how the monthly forecasts in Forecasting are to be split into daily or weekly forecasts for use by DRP, MPS or MRP.

Start Month

The month in which forecasts commence.

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